

HotCol — HR Module

Product brief for review & revision

Cafe & Restaurant · Hotel (and future lodging types)

Document	HR Module details (draft for revision)
Audience	Product / ops review with a collaborator
Status	Not implemented yet — listed as Coming soon in product
Goal	Agree scope before build (Core vs Advanced)

ONE-SENTENCE PITCH

HotCol HR should be a hospitality workforce module: know your people, schedule them, track leave and attendance, and optionally run payroll — sitting beside Credentials (logins), not replacing them.

1. Context in HotCol today

HotCol sells subscription modules for Cafe/Restaurant and Hotel (Resort/Pension coming later). Eight modules exist in the catalog. Seven are live; HR Module is the only product module still marked coming soon.

Modules already live (for orientation)

- Cafe and Restaurant — orders, kitchen, bar, cashier, waiters/tables
- Credentials (Common) — grant/delete staff logins (always required)
- Inventory — store terminal, stock, suppliers
- Credit Management — corporate credit
- Financial Management — cost control & finance (hotel)
- Room Management — reception, stays, laundry
- Cleaning and Maintenance — CM queues and assignments

What exists today that looks like “people” but is not HR

- Credentials = username + role + terminal access only
- Waiters = café floor identity + tip/income tracking (sales), not employment records
- Department leaders = free-text names for inventory accountability (includes an HR department code)
- CM assignees / credit “staff” = free-text names, not employee master data

There is no employee ID, attendance, leave, shift roster, contracts, or payroll in the product yet.

2. Recommended product shape

Best fit is a workforce-ops module for hospitality, not a full enterprise HCM (not BambooHR/SAP SuccessFactors clone). Sell it like Inventory or Rooms: optional module, gated by subscription, unlocking UI + an optional HR role.

2.1 Shared for Cafe and Hotel

- One module key: "HR Module" (available to both business types)
- Keep Credentials(Common) for logins — HR should link people to credentials, not replace them
- Reuse existing department codes (Kitchen, Bar, Housekeeping, Reception, Maintenance, Finance, HR, etc.)
- Prefer one grantable role: HR !' /HR terminal (Manager/Admin tabs also fin

2.2 Cafe vs Hotel differences

Topic	Cafe / Restaurant	Hotel
Owner UI	Admin tab / panel	Manager tab + scorecard
HR role	Optional (Admin can run alone)	Strongly recommended
Departments	Kitchen, Bar, Floor, Store	+ Rooms, CM, Security, night ops
Waiters	Keep separate; optional link later	Only if Cafe module subscribed
Shifts	Short / split shifts common	24/7 rotating & night shifts
Finance link	Often no Finance module	Natural with Financial Mgmt

IMPORTANT RULE

Do not fold waiters into HR in v1. Waiters are sales/tip identity today. Optional

3. Phase A — HR Core (v1)

Ship value quickly: “know and schedule your people.” This is the recommended first release.

3.1 Capabilities

- Employee master — name, phone, department, job title, status (active / left)
- Optional link to a login credential (role/terminal)
- Leave requests + simple approve/reject (Manager/Admin or HR role)
- Basic attendance / shift roster by day and department
- Replace free-text people where useful (CM assignee, dept leader) with employee picker
- Manager/Admin scorecard: headcount, on leave today, open leave requests

3.2 Explicitly out of scope for v1

- Payroll, payslips, tax/pension calculations
- Full document vault / contracts lifecycle
- Recruiting / applicant tracking
- Performance reviews / OKRs
- Merging waiters into employee records

3.3 Suggested terminals / gating

- Opt-in module "HR Module" (remove Coming soon flag when ready)
- Grantable role: HR (ROLE_REQUIRED_MODULE = HR Module)
- Admin (cafe) and Manager (hotel) can host HR tabs even without dedicated HR staff
- Add pricing tier when sold (signup pricing currently ignores HR)

4. Phase B+ — Advanced HR

Advanced = Core + employment files + timekeeping that drives pay + payroll (incl. tips) + Finance handoff. Still hospitality-focused, not full talent suites.

4.1 Employment & documents

- Contracts, start/end dates, probation, wage type (hourly / monthly / tip-eligible)
- Document vault: ID, contracts, certificates
- Onboarding / offboarding checklists (uniform, keys, revoke credential)

4.2 Time that drives pay

- PIN / biometric-style clock-in, late/absent flags, overtime rules
- Shift templates by department (kitchen morning, reception night, CM floors)
- Timesheet approval ! feeds payroll
- Support split shifts (common in F&B and lodging)

4.3 Leave policy

- Leave types with balances (annual, sick, unpaid)
- Accrual rules and blackout dates (peak season / holidays)
- Dual approval for larger hotels; Admin alone for small cafés

4.4 Payroll (the big jump)

- Gross from salary / hours / overtime / tips
- Deductions: tax, pension, advances, absences (Ethiopia-oriented; TIN already in product)
- Payslips, period close, export/posting to Finance when subscribed
- Tip pooling for café waiters — bridge existing tip/income arrays into payroll

4.5 Light performance & optional recruiting

- Probation reviews, simple role scorecards, warnings/incidents
- Optional recruiting pipeline for high-turnover hotel roles (HK, F&B)

4.6 Cross-module bridges (what makes it “HotCol advanced”)

Existing gap	Advanced HR closes it
Credentials	Employee !” login; offboard revokes access
Waiters	Employment + tip settlement into payroll
CM / dept leaders	Pick active employees, not free text
Credit STAFF	Link registrant to employee
Finance module	Payroll period as cost / payable
Manager scorecard	Labor cost %, OT, turnover

5. Suggested packaging

Either one subscription with add-ons, or clear tiers. Recommended packaging:

Package	Includes
HR Core	Employee master, leave, light roster
HR Time	Clock + shift templates + timesheets
HR Pay	Payroll, tips, payslips, Finance export
HR Hire (optional)	Recruiting pipeline

PRACTICAL BUILD ORDER

1) Core !' 2) Time !' 3) Pay !' 4) Hire. Scorecards last. Do not start with rec

6. Questions for your revision

Please mark Agree / Change / Defer next to each:

- Is Core (employee + leave + light roster) the right v1?
- Should Café and Hotel share one module key (recommended: yes)?
- Dedicated HR role required for Hotel from day one, or Manager-only first?
- Keep Waiters separate until Pay phase?
- Is payroll in-scope for year 1, or Core+Time only?
- Any Ethiopia-specific payroll rules we must lock early (tax/pension)?
- Should free-text CM assignees move to employee picker in Core or later?
- Pricing: flat HR fee vs Core / Time / Pay add-ons?

7. Revision notes (write here)

SUMMARY FOR DECISION

Build hospitality workforce ops first (people, leave, shifts). Add time & payroll when Core is trusted. Never confuse HR Module with Credentials. Café and Hotel share the module; Hotel needs deeper shift/department support.